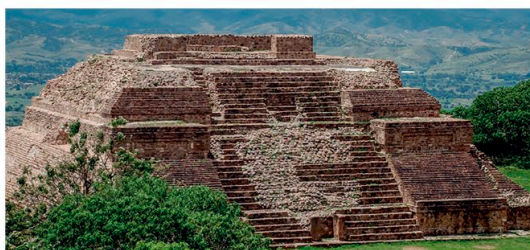


c. 500 BCE

ZAPOTECs ESTABLISH MONTE ALBÁN

As the Zapotec civilization flourished, a site in the southern Mexican highlands was chosen as its centre. The Zapotecs began to build Monte Albán – the first great city of Mesoamerica – on a steep hill in the Oaxaca valley.



△ Monte Albán, Zapotec ruins

500 BCE

496 BCE Greek dramatist Sophocles, author of tragedies featuring Antigone and Oedipus, is born

480 BCE Emperor Xerxes I bridges the Hellespont and the Persian army advances as far as Athens

499–449 BCE In the Greco-Persian Wars, the Greeks defend against Persian invasion in a series of famous battles

c. 490 BCE King Ajatashatru founds Pataliputra (modern Patna) in north-east India, as capital of the Magadha Empire

490 BCE
ATHENIANS DEFEAT PERSIANS AT MARATHON

A decisive battle in the Greco-Persian Wars took place at Marathon, Attica, during the first Persian invasion. Darius I planned to take the whole of Greece, sending his forces by sea to Attica. They were met on the coastal plain at Marathon by Athenian troops who, though outnumbered, outmanoeuvred the Persians and won a crushing victory.

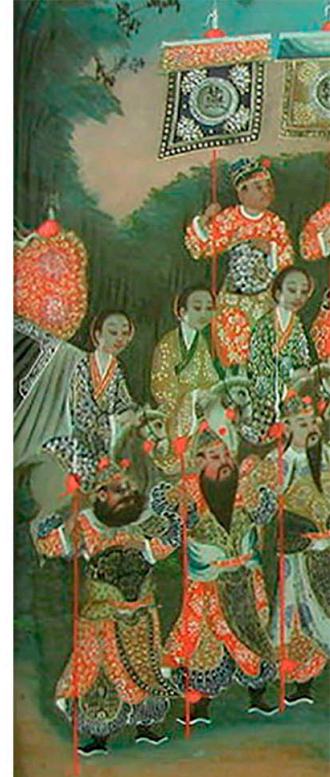


△ Athenian battle helmet

475 BCE
WARRING STATES PERIOD BEGINS IN CHINA

By the beginning of the 5th century BCE, the Zhou kingdom in China had fragmented into several more or less autonomous states. As they vied with one another for power in the region, the Spring and Autumn Period came to an end and was replaced by a time of political turmoil known as the Warring States Period. The conflict was to continue for a further two and a half centuries until the Qin state, with its strict authoritarian regime and disciplined military, emerged victorious.

▷ **Conference of Six States** in the Warring States Period



△ The Buddha, seated statue

c. 480 BCE
TEACHINGS OF THE BUDDHA

Siddhartha Gautama, known later as the Buddha, spent the latter part of his life preaching in northern India. After his death, his disciples collated his teachings and continued to spread his ideas further afield, establishing Buddhism as a major religion.